

Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer - RETIRED

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

13-3

Manual Section Number

110.17

Manual Section Title

Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer - RETIRED

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

02/25/2026

Implementation Date

10/05/2026

Description Information

Benefit Category

Incident to a physician's professional Service

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

Oxaliplatin (Eloxatin™), irinotecan (Camptosar®), cetuximab (Erbix™), and bevacizumab (Avastin™) are anti-cancer chemotherapeutic agents approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the treatment of colorectal cancer. Anti-cancer chemotherapeutic agents are eligible for coverage when used in accordance with FDA-approved labeling (see section 1861(t)(2)(B) of the Social Security Act (the Act)), when the off-label use is supported in one of the authoritative drug compendia listed in section 1861(t)(2)(B)(ii)(I) of the Act, or when the Medicare Administrative Contractor (MAC) determines an off-label use

is medically accepted based on guidance provided by the Secretary (section 1861(t)(2)(B)(ii) (II)).

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

110.17 – Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer (RETIRED)

(Rev. 13748; Issued: 04-23-26; Effective: 02-25-26; Implementation: 10-05-26)

Effective February 25, 2026, the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) removed NCD 110.17, ending coverage of the off-label use of clinical items and services, including the use of the studied drugs oxaliplatin, irinotecan, cetuximab, or bevacizumab, in specific clinical trials identified by CMS. Other coverage mechanisms remain available for these items and services under the Clinical Trial Policy NCD 310.1 and, separately, under § 1861(t)(2)(B) of the Act.

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

13748

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/files/document/r13748NCD.pdf> 

Revision History

04/2026 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to inform contractors that, effective February 25, 2026, CMS reconsidered NCD 110.17 and made a final determination to remove the NCD in its entirety. ([TN 13748](#) ) (CR 14433)

06/2005 - Use of oxaliplatin (Eloxatin™), irinotecan (Camptosar®), cetuximab (Erbix™), or bevacizumab (Avastin™) covered in clinical trials identified by CMS and sponsored by National Cancer Institute. Effective date 01/28/2005. Implementation date 04/18/2005 for Carriers, 07/05/2005 for FI's. ([TN 38](#) ) (CR 3742)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Anticancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer \(CAG-00179N\)](#) 
- [First reconsideration for Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer \(CAG-00179R\)](#) 

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer - RETIRED	2	02/25/2026 - N/A	You are here
Anti-Cancer Chemotherapy for Colorectal Cancer	1	01/28/2005 - 02/25/2026	View